

METaverse: “LEGALLY” NOT A MONOPOLY

BUT “LOGICALLY” ...

Introduction

- Meta (formerly Facebook) is one of the world's largest digital media corporations, operating global platforms such as **Facebook, Instagram, and WhatsApp.**
- The company's revenue model is primarily advertising based, relying on data extraction and audience commodification.



- Meta plays a dominant role in the global media ecosystem, shaping digital communication, platform governance, and user behaviour.
- Applying the Political Economy of Media reveals that Meta's approach primarily extends its established economic logic rather than disrupting it.

(Kraus et al., 2022)



FEDERAL TRADE COMMISSIONS (FTC) VS META LAWSUIT

- A legal battle lasted almost **5 years** contending Meta's business as **monopoly**
- **FTC alleged** Meta is trying to **neutralise their competitors** (via **Profitability, QAP, and Price Discriminations**)
- Final Verdict: Meta is **NOT engaging in monopoly**

(U.S. Congress, 2025, Sullcrom, 2025)

*Snow Crash (1992) by Neal
Stephenson*

POLITICAL MEDIA OF ECONOMY (PEM) AND METAVERSE

- **PEM:** Relationship between how politic and economic influence media landscape
- Media portrayals ≠ The **actual legal framework**
- **Hostile power dynamic** making information circulation **disputable**.

(Gilbert, 2022, Pollution Sustainability, 2025)

Overview of the Case

Meta's Role in the Media Ecosystem

WHAT IS THE MEDIA ECOSYSTEM?

- **Enable virtual interactions** among users, public figures, politicians to disseminate information, persuade audiences, promote ideas in other forms of communication.
- People across the globe have **prospered together** due to connectivity, enhanced the exchange of opinions on current issues via social media (*Sarwar et al., 2023*).

SHAPING PUBLIC DISCOURSE

- Meta is known for its **extensive ownership** in social media platforms where it works as a major channel for news circulation.
- Research indicates that social media algorithms **prioritise content based on engagement standards**, subtly constructing public discourse by amplifying certain narratives across the network which raises concerns about algorithmic transparency and the accuracy.
- Certain news content **may contain hidden agendas**, potentially leading to the manipulation of public discourse.

Meta's Role in the Media Ecosystem

FREE DIGITAL LABOUR

- **Unpaid activities** of users that **create an economic value** for the company through targeted advertising and data extraction
- **Inadvertently increase a company's revenue** as high users' participation in social media attracts advertisers and transforms users into a valuable commodity
- The actual customers are the large corporations that purchase access to users' data in order to deliver targeted advertisements to their certain audiences.

REGULATES INFORMATION

- Meta **shapes** what information circulates by structuring terms and conditions
- For instance, social media platforms operate through a centralised system of interaction where features such as liking, sharing and commenting are designed to maximise user engagement.
- To amplify, political content on news feeds or reels that provokes audiences' emotional responses is more likely to spread rapidly.



Impact to Society

Meta's massive influence reduces pressure for systemic change. Societal consequences are borne by users, not the platform

Privacy Erosion

- Large-scale data collection with limited user control
- Power imbalance between platform and users raises ethical concerns

Market Competition

- Acquisitions and dominance restrict smaller competitors
- Ownership concentration limits innovation and platform diversity

User Experience

- Algorithms prioritize engagement and ad revenue
- Sensational content and misinformation are amplified

Conclusion

THAT IS ALL,

THANK YOU!